

ESSENTIAL

Financial Requirements Overview

The maintenance-fund formula, the 28-day rule, and acceptable evidence

VERIFY BEFORE YOU APPLY

Fees, forms, and processing times change without notice. This guide reflects publicly documented procedures as commonly published; treat every dollar figure, form number, and timeline here as a starting point, and confirm the current version on the official government site before you submit anything or pay any fee.

This route has a published, formula-based requirement

Unlike the Standard Visitor visa (which has no fixed minimum), the Student visa's financial requirement is a specific, published formula covering two components: your course fees, and a fixed monthly living-cost figure. This is genuinely different from the Visitor route's "sufficient funds" test - see that visa type's own documents if you're also applying for a Visitor visa separately.

The formula

- Course fees payable: your first year's tuition fees (as stated on your CAS), minus any deposit you've already paid to your sponsor
- Living costs: a fixed monthly rate, multiplied by the number of months of your course, up to a maximum of 9 months - even if your course runs longer than 9 months, you only need to evidence living costs for 9 months
- The monthly living-cost rate differs depending on whether your course is in London or elsewhere in the UK - check the current published rates on gov.uk, since these are updated periodically and are not reproduced as a fixed figure here

Total required = course fees payable + (monthly living-cost rate × number of months, capped at 9). See the Financial Planning Calculator (Premium tier) for a live version of this formula you can fill in with your own numbers and the current published rates.

The 28-day rule

HOLD YOUR FUNDS FOR 28 CONSECUTIVE DAYS

The required amount must be held in your (or your permitted sponsor's) account for a continuous 28-day period, and your application must be made no more than 31 days after the end of that 28-day period. If the balance drops below the required amount on even one day within that window, the evidence generally doesn't count - plan your application date around this, not the other way round.

Who can provide the funds

- You, personally, in your own account
- A parent or legal guardian (with evidence of the relationship and a letter of consent to use their funds)
- An official financial sponsor - a government, international organisation, or your own institution's scholarship scheme, which can substitute a sponsorship letter for the amount it covers

What doesn't count

- Funds that appeared shortly before the 28-day window with no plausible source
- Evidence in an account type or currency not accepted under the current rules - check the specific acceptable-evidence list on gov.uk, which is more prescriptive here than on the Visitor route
- A sponsorship letter that doesn't clearly state the amount and duration of the funding commitment